Elizabeth Koch

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Active Secret Clearance (TS/SCI Sponsorship Eligible)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Enterprise Product and Engineering Executive driving secure cloud modernization and product practice development across defense and federal environments, including the Department of the Air Force, U.S. Space Force, and Department of Veterans Affairs. Built and scaled Clarity Innovations' product management practice of 15 product managers delivering on programs. Engineering-fluent: CS Degree; Python, JavaScript, React, SQL; AWS/GCP; CI/CD and DevSecOps. Proven at building product organizations and shipping under federal constraints.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Clarity Innovations
July 2023 – Present

Engineering Director, Product Management

- Built and scaled the product management practice: **15 product managers** supporting engineering teams across programs, with standards, playbooks, PM coaching, and career development.
- Built an **AI-driven product operating system** on Anthropic's Claude platform, with custom agentic skills, multi-perspective review agents, and automated workflows that standardize discovery, specs, prioritization, and stakeholder communication across the product practice; presented **"AI Confidence vs. AI Competence"** to the practice to set the bar for effective, responsible AI adoption in PM work.

Cloud One Customer Enablement, United States Air Force

- Direct product strategy for **Cloud One DSOT** (formerly Operation Swift Shield), the Department of the Air Force's enterprise application modernization program, onboarding 186 Mission System Owners (MSOs) to secure cloud infrastructure through automated, security-scanned CI/CD pipelines under ATO constraints.
- Transitioned DSOT program reporting from activity-based tracking to outcome-focused performance indicators tied to cost efficiency and operational readiness.
- Designed governance and onboarding frameworks that accelerated secure system adoption while reducing operational overhead and compliance friction.
- Advise executive leadership on modernization strategy, risk alignment, and multi-million-dollar program investment prioritization.
- Institutionalized automation, observability, and secure-by-design practices across the product lifecycle.

Product Manager, Guardian One, U.S. Space Force

- Delivered **USSF Guardian One**, achieving an **unprecedented Certificate to Field (CtF) in 42 days**, through DAF software-factory infrastructure (BESPIN, Cantina CI/CD pipelines) under cATO compliance.
- Expanded the product portfolio by bringing in the **Space Force Portal** and led its platform transition from **Cloud One to Gravity**.

- Presented **"Guardian One: Revolutionizing Capability Development in the U.S. Space Force"** at the Department of the Air Force Information Technology and Cyberpower Conference 2024.

Blue Tiger
September 2022 – June 2023

Senior Product Manager, VA Identity Modernization

Led modernization of the VA's authentication platform enabling secure digital access for **~15 million U.S. veterans**.

- Directed federated identity integration across enterprise systems, coordinating engineering, security, and compliance stakeholders across multiple agencies.
- Defined reliability, adoption, and authentication success metrics; delivered iterative improvements that strengthened authentication reliability and reduced access-related service disruptions.

UKG / Ultimate Software
January 2010 – July 2022

Senior Product Manager, Cloud Environment Services

- Owned the cloud environment portfolio for the organization: development environments for every product development team, plus the demo and training environments behind pre-sales and customer education.
- Conceived and delivered **"Clone Wars,"** an internal SaaS platform that replaced manual VM copies with self-service provisioning for sales demos and customer training alike: users select the HCM products they need and spin up an environment seeded with scrambled data **in minutes**, eliminating hours of manual setup and the instability of locally copied VMs.
- Reduced demo and training environment outages through preventive controls and stronger engineering partnerships.

Lead, Global Security Identity & Access Management

- Implemented role-based access control across the multi-product SaaS organization, strengthening security posture, audit readiness, and operational efficiency.
- Built the enterprise IAM function from the ground up and established it as the organization's authority for access decisions and issue resolution.
- Developed a high-performing IAM team through structured mentorship, regular feedback, and career development.

Cineworks Digital Studios
April 2004 – January 2010

Director of Information Technology

- Directed global IT operations and infrastructure strategy for a growing digital media company.
- Scaled secure, resilient technology systems supporting international expansion.
- Provided executive-level technology advisory and roadmap planning.

EDUCATION

HARVARD UNIVERSITY Extension School, Cambridge, MA

- Master of Liberal Arts (ALM), Digital Media Design, Expected May 2027, GPA 3.92
- Bachelor of Liberal Arts (ALB), Computer Science, May 2024, Cum Laude, GPA 3.6
- Graduate Certificates: Front-End Web Development, Back-End Web Development, Learning

Design and Technology

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

- **Certifications:** Certified SAFe® 6 Product Owner/Product Manager | Certified Scrum Product Owner® (CSPO®) | Certified Incident Responder
- **Executive Leadership:** Product Organization Design | Digital Transformation | Governance & Risk Alignment | Executive Stakeholder Engagement | Cross-Functional Team Leadership
- **Product & Platform Strategy:** Product Lifecycle Leadership | Platform Modernization | User-Centered Design | DevSecOps Integration | Outcome-Based Roadmaps
- **AI & Agentic Systems:** Anthropic Claude / Claude Code | OpenAI ChatGPT | Agentic Workflow & Custom Skill Development | Multi-Agent Orchestration | AI-Assisted Product Operations
- **Cloud & Technical Fluency:** AWS | GCP | Identity & Access Management (IAM) | CI/CD | SQL | Python | JavaScript | React
- **Product & Collaboration Tools:** Atlassian Suite | Figma | Miro | FigJam | Lucidchart | Microsoft 365 | Google Workspace | Adobe Creative Cloud